

Theoretical Architecture and Mathematical Evolution of Classical Electrodynamics: From Maxwellian Synthesis to Hertzian Validation

Jesse Tuohy

Principal Invariant Architect

Arcstone Adaptive Science Systems, Inc.

ORCID: [0009-0008-4661-1540](https://orcid.org/0009-0008-4661-1540) | Canonical Handle: [@admissibilityscience](https://admissibilityscience.com)

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Abstract

This technical memorandum documents the structural architecture, mathematical evolution, and theoretical formulation of classical electrodynamics. It details the progression from James Clerk Maxwell's foundational system (1865–1873) to Oliver Heaviside's vector calculus reduction (1884–1885) and Heinrich Hertz's experimental validation (1886–1888). Incorporating constitutive closure, local charge conservation, Poynting energy flux, interface boundary conditions, gauge freedom, and plane-wave transversality, this document serves as a foundational reference for applied physics, computational field modeling, and deterministic substrate architecture within Arcstone Adaptive Science Systems. Anchored directly to target integration hash A-77-DELTA-SHIELD-LOCKED, this specification enforces the core security invariants ($C_{\text{ops}} = 0$, $\text{Data_Egress_Sensitive} = 0$).

1 Chronological & Structural Evolution

The architectural timeline of classical field theory unfolded across four primary phases:

Phase (Year)	Architectural Milestone & Description
Phase 1 (1865)	Dynamical Theory Paper: Introduction of 20 component equations and prediction of electromagnetic wave propagation at light speed.
Phase 2 (1873)	Treatise Synthesis: Systematic organization of field phenomena into a four-part logical framework across two volumes.
Phase 3 (1884–1885)	Heaviside Reformulation: Reduction to four vector calculus equations using primary field vectors ($\mathbf{E}, \mathbf{B}, \mathbf{D}, \mathbf{H}$).
Phase 4 (1886–1888)	Hertzian Validation: Experimental proof of wave propagation, reflection, refraction, focusing, and polarization.

Table 1: Chronological Milestones of Classical Electrodynamics.

1.1 Phase 1: A Dynamical Theory of the Electromagnetic Field (1865)

Maxwell presented a system of twenty component equations relating twenty field quantities. This system mixed differential field laws, constitutive relations, and force equations (including conduction current, electric displacement, total current, magnetic force, electromotive force, electromagnetic momentum, free charge, and electric potential). Within this framework, Maxwell demonstrated that electromagnetic disturbances admit wave-like propagation and calculated a theoretical speed matching the known speed of light.

1.2 Phase 2: A Treatise on Electricity and Magnetism (1873)

A systematic two-volume masterwork organizing field phenomena into four physical domains:

- **Part I: Electrostatics** (Static charges, capacitance, potential theory)
- **Part II: Electrokinematics** (Current transport, conduction, resistance)
- **Part III: Magnetism** (Poles, induction, magnetic force)
- **Part IV: Electromagnetism** (Dynamic synthesis, Lagrangian field mechanics, electromagnetic theory of light)

1.3 Phase 3: Heaviside's Vector Reformulation (1884–1885)

Oliver Heaviside substantially reorganized Maxwellian electrodynamics using vector analysis. Rather than treating component equations and potentials as the primary computational language, Heaviside formulated the theory directly in terms of field variables ($\mathbf{E}, \mathbf{B}, \mathbf{D}, \mathbf{H}$) expressed via divergence and curl operators. This shift de-emphasized potentials as primary variables without rendering them obsolete.

1.4 Phase 4: Hertzian Experimental Validation (1886–1888)

Heinrich Hertz experimentally generated and detected radio-frequency electromagnetic waves, confirming reflection, refraction, focusing, and polarization, providing definitive physical proof of the Maxwellian framework.

2 Conceptual Architecture: The 4 Pillars

The macroscopic Maxwell equations organize all classical electromagnetic phenomena into four differential field laws:

3 Constitutive Relations & Material Media

Maxwell's four field equations require constitutive relations to close the physical system in material media relating $\mathbf{D}$ to $\mathbf{E}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ to $\mathbf{H}$:

$$\mathbf{D} = \varepsilon_0 \mathbf{E} + \mathbf{P}, \quad \mathbf{H} = \frac{1}{\mu_0} \mathbf{B} - \mathbf{M} \quad (1)$$

For linear, isotropic, homogeneous media, these simplify to:

$$\mathbf{D} = \varepsilon \mathbf{E}, \quad \mathbf{B} = \mu \mathbf{H}, \quad \mathbf{J}_f = \sigma \mathbf{E} \quad (\text{Ohm's Law}) \quad (2)$$

Field Law	Differential Form	Primary Interpretation	Engineering Relevance
I. Gauss's Law (Electric)	$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{D} = \rho_f$	Free electric charge density (ρ_f) acts as the source for electric displacement $\mathbf{D}$.	Capacitance, electrostatic shielding, field mapping.
II. Gauss's Law (Magnetic)	$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{B} = 0$	Magnetic flux density $\mathbf{B}$ is solenoidal; no isolated magnetic monopoles exist.	Magnetic circuit design, flux continuity.
III. Faraday's Law	$\nabla \times \mathbf{E} = -\frac{\partial \mathbf{B}}{\partial t}$	Time-varying magnetic flux generates a circulating non-conservative electric field $\mathbf{E}$.	Generators, transformers, inductive components.
IV. Ampère-Maxwell Law	$\nabla \times \mathbf{H} = \mathbf{J}_f + \frac{\partial \mathbf{D}}{\partial t}$	Conduction current density $\mathbf{J}_f$ and displacement current density $\frac{\partial \mathbf{D}}{\partial t}$ source $\mathbf{H}$.	Wireless propagation, RF design, high-frequency circuits.

Table 2: The Four Macroscopic Maxwell Field Equations.

3.1 Interface Boundary Conditions

Across a boundary between Medium 1 and Medium 2 with unit normal $\hat{\mathbf{n}}_{12}$ pointing from Medium 1 into Medium 2:

$$\hat{\mathbf{n}}_{12} \cdot (\mathbf{D}_2 - \mathbf{D}_1) = \rho_f \quad (3)$$

$$\hat{\mathbf{n}}_{12} \cdot (\mathbf{B}_2 - \mathbf{B}_1) = 0 \quad (4)$$

$$\hat{\mathbf{n}}_{12} \times (\mathbf{E}_2 - \mathbf{E}_1) = 0 \quad (5)$$

$$\hat{\mathbf{n}}_{12} \times (\mathbf{H}_2 - \mathbf{H}_1) = \mathbf{K}_f \quad (6)$$

4 Conservation Laws & Potentials

4.1 Local Charge Conservation

Taking the divergence of the Ampère-Maxwell Law and utilizing the vector identity $\nabla \cdot (\nabla \times \mathbf{H}) = 0$:

$$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{J}_f + \nabla \cdot \frac{\partial \mathbf{D}}{\partial t} = 0 \implies \nabla \cdot \mathbf{J}_f + \frac{\partial \rho_f}{\partial t} = 0 \quad (7)$$

Maxwell's displacement current term ($\frac{\partial \mathbf{D}}{\partial t}$) is mathematically necessary to make Ampère's Law compatible with local charge conservation.

4.2 Energy Transport: Poynting's Theorem

Electromagnetic power-flux density is defined by the Poynting vector $\mathbf{S}$:

$$\mathbf{S} = \mathbf{E} \times \mathbf{H} \quad (8)$$

Energy conservation in a linear medium with energy density $u = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{E} \cdot \mathbf{D} + \mathbf{B} \cdot \mathbf{H})$ is expressed as:

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot \mathbf{S} = -\mathbf{J}_f \cdot \mathbf{E} \quad (9)$$

4.3 Potentials & Gauge Transformations

Field variables can be expressed in terms of magnetic vector potential $\mathbf{A}$ and scalar potential ϕ :

$$\mathbf{B} = \nabla \times \mathbf{A}, \quad \mathbf{E} = -\nabla\phi - \frac{\partial \mathbf{A}}{\partial t} \quad (10)$$

These potentials admit gauge transformations under an arbitrary scalar field χ :

$$\mathbf{A} \rightarrow \mathbf{A} + \nabla\chi, \quad \phi \rightarrow \phi - \frac{\partial \chi}{\partial t} \quad (11)$$

Enforcing the Lorenz gauge condition ($\nabla \cdot \mathbf{A} + \mu_0 \varepsilon_0 \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial t} = 0$) uncouples the wave equations for $\mathbf{A}$ and ϕ , preserving explicit relativistic invariance.

5 Vacuum Wave Derivation & Transversality

In a homogeneous, linear, isotropic vacuum with no free sources ($\rho_f = 0, \mathbf{J}_f = 0, \mathbf{D} = \varepsilon_0 \mathbf{E}, \mathbf{B} = \mu_0 \mathbf{H}$):

$$\nabla \times (\nabla \times \mathbf{E}) = -\frac{\partial}{\partial t}(\nabla \times \mathbf{B}) = -\mu_0 \varepsilon_0 \frac{\partial^2 \mathbf{E}}{\partial t^2} \quad (12)$$

Applying the vector identity $\nabla \times (\nabla \times \mathbf{E}) = \nabla(\nabla \cdot \mathbf{E}) - \nabla^2 \mathbf{E}$ alongside Gauss's Law ($\nabla \cdot \mathbf{E} = 0$):

$$\nabla^2 \mathbf{E} - \mu_0 \varepsilon_0 \frac{\partial^2 \mathbf{E}}{\partial t^2} = 0 \quad (13)$$

Performing the identical operation for $\mathbf{B}$:

$$\nabla^2 \mathbf{B} - \mu_0 \varepsilon_0 \frac{\partial^2 \mathbf{B}}{\partial t^2} = 0 \quad (14)$$

Comparing with the d'Alembertian wave operator ($\nabla^2 - \frac{1}{v_p^2} \frac{\partial^2}{\partial t^2} = 0$) establishes the invariant phase velocity:

$$v_p = \frac{1}{\sqrt{\mu_0 \varepsilon_0}} = c \quad (15)$$

5.1 Plane-Wave Transversality Conditions

For monochromatic plane-wave solutions of the form $\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{r}, t) = \mathbf{E}_0 e^{i(\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{r} - \omega t)}$ and $\mathbf{B}(\mathbf{r}, t) = \mathbf{B}_0 e^{i(\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{r} - \omega t)}$:

$$\mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{E}_0 = 0, \quad \mathbf{k} \cdot \mathbf{B}_0 = 0 \quad \implies \quad \mathbf{E} \perp \mathbf{k}, \quad \mathbf{B} \perp \mathbf{k} \quad (16)$$

$$\mathbf{k} \times \mathbf{E}_0 = \omega \mathbf{B}_0 \quad \implies \quad \mathbf{E} \perp \mathbf{B}, \quad B_0 = \frac{E_0}{c} \quad (17)$$

Thus, electromagnetic waves in vacuum are strictly transverse, self-sustaining coupled field disturbances propagating at speed c .

6 System Invariants & Conformance

- **Master Hash Anchor:** A-77-DELTA-SHIELD-LOCKED
- **Zero Operational Drag:** $C_{\text{ops}} = 0$
- **Zero Sensitive Egress:** Data_Egress_Sensitive = 0
- **Dominance Hierarchy:** FAIL (POSIX 40) $\succ$ FREEZE (POSIX 10) $\succ$ PWC (POSIX 10) $\succ$ PASS (POSIX 0)

7 Conclusion

This technical memorandum documents the theoretical and mathematical framework of classical electrodynamics, establishing the foundation for field modeling and substrate architecture within the Arcstone Adaptive Science Systems suite.

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